Visual Identity & System Guidelines

FORMAT: A3 Broadsheet (420×297mm) | VERSION: v1.0 (2026) | APPLICATION: Web · Physical · Brand

01 Brand & Voice

00 GUIDING PRINCIPLE

A compass, not a rulebook. We build software, AI agents, and data tools around how teams actually operate. Our visual identity reflects that: grounded, unpretentious, and human. Whether designing a client dashboard, marketing website, or print stationery, keep every touchpoint tactile, functional, and devoid of agency fluff.

TEAM STRUCTURE & ETHOS

Two senior operators: Direct client-to-builder collaboration. No account managers, no six-month slide decks, no synthetic buzzwords.

CORE PERSONALITY ATTRIBUTES

Grounded Rooted in operational reality	**Practical** Utility over speculative hype
Collaborative Working directly alongside teams	**Helpful** Reducing cognitive burden
Approachable Warm, plainspoken, Dutch craft	**Small on Purpose** Agile, personal, high focus

VOICE & TONE RULES

- **Speak like a person:** Be direct, warm, and conversational. Write like you speak over coffee.
- **Active verbs:** Lead with what software does (*"Turning incoming messages into ready-to-send replies"*).
- **No synthetic metrics:** Ban fake percentage badges and vanity stats. Real utility requires no hype.
- **Human-in-the-loop:** When presenting automation, always showcase the human verification and sign-off step.

EDITORIAL VOICE MATRIX

~~"Enterprise-grade cognitive AI synergy platform."~~
"Software that organizes incoming orders and drafts replies."

~~"Revolutionizing human capital via neural pipelines."~~
"Tools built around the way your team actually works."

~~"Autonomous seamless omnichannel orchestration."~~
"Direct integrations that stop manual copy-pasting."

VISUAL ANTI-PATTERNS

- **No generic AI tropes:** Never use neon glowing orbs, floating 3D plastic cubes, or purple/indigo gradients.
- **No cartoon people:** Show human teams through their tools, data views, or documentary photography.
- **No bloated bentos:** Avoid decorative card mosaics packed with meaningless icon filler.

02 Typography & Scale

PRIMARY FONT FAMILIES

- **Display — Sintony Bold:** Architectural geometric sans with Dutch humanist weight. Used for hero statements, H1/H2 titles, and focal numbers.
- **Body & UI — Poppins:** Open, legible geometric sans across screen DPIs and offset print. Regular 400 for text, Medium 500 for subtitles, SemiBold 600 for UI.
- **Technical — JetBrains Mono:** Crisp monospace for data tokens, status flags, code, and micro-labels.

FONT SPECIMEN PREVIEWS

SINTONY 700	Aa Bb Cc Gg Rr 0 1 2 3 4 5
POPPINS 500	Aa Bb Cc Gg Rr & % / + =
JB MONO 500	0x2F [READY] 14:02 #FF6037

TYPESCALE & HIERARCHY

HERO 80px / 1.08	Light work.
H1 TITLE 38px / 1.12	Turning incoming messages.
H2 SUBTITLE 20px / 1.45	Software built around your team.
BODY 14px / 1.70	AI and software that fit how you operate.
EYEBROW 11px / +0.14em	01 — WORKFLOW AUTOMATION
CODE / META 10.5px / Mono	LATENCY: 14ms · RUN_ID: #885b1d81

UNIVERSAL TYPESETTING RULES

- **Sentence case standard:** Use natural sentence case for all headlines, subheads, and buttons. Reject aggressive Title Casing.
- **Tracked caps exception:** Uppercase is permitted ONLY for eyebrows and micro-tags; always track with `+0.12em` to `+0.18em`.
- **Tabular numbers:** In UI dashboards, tables, and metric counters, enable `font-variant-numeric: tabular-nums`.
- **Line measure:** Keep running editorial text between 45 and 70 characters per line to guarantee comfortable reading cadence.
- **Container breathing room:** Never crowd text against container edges. Maintain tested vertical padding on all cards.

03 Color Architecture

MATERIAL PALETTE SPECIFICATIONS

Canvas — #F5F4ED
RGB: 245, 244, 237 · CMYK: 2, 2, 6, 0
Primary substrate, paper stock, card background wash

Sand (Alabaster) — #ECE8E1
RGB: 236, 232, 225 · CMYK: 5, 5, 9, 2
Secondary cards, founder surfaces, warm track neutral

Espresso — #351E1C
RGB: 53, 30, 28 · CMYK: 45, 65, 62, 68
Primary ink, titles, main body, high-contrast borders

Terracotta — #733635
RGB: 115, 54, 53 · CMYK: 30, 75, 65, 35
Eyebrows, subtitles, metadata tags, hairline dividers

Coral — #FF6037
RGB: 255, 96, 55 · CMYK: 0, 75, 80, 0
Focal action CTA, active pins, single focal point per viewport

Aqua — #A0C9CB
RGB: 160, 201, 203 · CMYK: 30, 5, 15, 5
Data vectors, water pathways, secondary tool highlights

ATMOSPHERIC WASHES (LIVE WEBSITE)

Subtle horizontal mineral washes used across live case study sections:

01 Soft Coral (Workflow & Process)	#F5F4ED → #F9BCA8 → #ECE8E1
02 Mineral Aqua (Clean Water Agency)	#F5F4ED → #C2DAD9 → #ECE8E1
03 Limestone Wash (Pricing Tool)	#F5F4ED → #D7C8C3 → #ECE8E1

CONTRAST & SUBSTRATE HIERARCHY

Contrast verification: Espresso on Canvas provides **14.2:1 (AAA)**. Terracotta on Canvas provides **7.1:1 (AAA)**. Coral on Espresso achieves **4.8:1 (AA)**.
Print paper specification: For stationery and physical cards, specify 450–600gsm uncoated warm cotton stock (FSC-certified). Avoid synthetic high-gloss lamination.

04 System & Collateral

THE MICRO-CHAMFER RULE

We firmly reject rounded-full pill shapes and generic 20px bubble cards. Keizersgracht relies on an architectural micro-radius:

✓ APPROVED SPEC
2px – 3px radius
Sharp, tactile, architectural micro-chamfer

✕ FORBIDDEN
16px+ / Pill radius
Generic SaaS bubble shape, strictly banned

- **Cards & dialog sheets:** `3px` radius with subtle warm shadow `0 10px 24px rgba(115, 54, 53, 0.08)`.
- **Buttons, inputs, tags:** `2px` radius.
- **Micro-rules & bars:** `1px` radius.

SPATIAL 8-POINT RHYTHM

8px	16px	24px	32px	48px	64px

All layout margins, card padding, and flex gaps derive strictly from multiples of 8px.

PRIMARY ACTION ANATOMY

Interactive Trigger
radius: 2px · #FF6037

GRAB A COFFEE →

PHOTOGRAPHY & VISUAL MEDIA

Documentary realism: Real founders, physical team spaces, and operational workflows only. Strict rectangular crops with zero rounded corners and zero vignette fade.
Warm mineral grade: Layered with a **3% warm Coral tint** (`rgba(255, 96, 55, 0.03)`) and hairline border (`rgba(53, 30, 28, 0.08)`).

UNIVERSAL COLLATERAL GUIDELINES

- **Material honesty:** Digital interfaces simulate heavyweight matte paper stock. Never use synthetic glassmorphism or high-gloss reflections.
- **Cross-media consistency:** Whether rendering a web application, an internal terminal, a business card, or branded packaging, adhere to the 3px micro-chamfer and 8px rhythm.